

Breast Feeding



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Breast Feeding

- **Breast milk** is the natural and ideal food that satisfies the needs of the infants.





Breast Feeding

- **Stages of breast milk production:**

1) **Colostrum:** it is produced in the seventh month of pregnancy until the first post partum week. It is thick, sticky, and clear to yellowish in color. Colostrum is the perfect first food and have many important benefits for the newborn infants.
2) **Transitional milk:** the milk produced between the colostrum and mature milk is called transitional milk and takes place in the second week post partum.
3) **Mature breast milk:** mature milk is produced after two weeks post partum.

Breast Feeding

- **Advantages of breast feeding:**

A. Benefits to the baby:

1. **Composition:** human milk is ideally suited to the needs of the human infant in both quantity and quality.
2. **Convenience:** breast milk is ready to serve anytime and anywhere, needs no preparation, is always fresh and is supplied at the proper temperature.
3. **Sterility:** breast milk is sterile and uncontaminated.
4. **Anti-infective properties:** breast milk have many protective factors that enhances infant's immunity and protect him against infections.

Breast Feeding

- **Advantages of breast feeding:**

A. Benefits to the baby:

1. **Low allergenicity:** breastfed babies are much less prone to allergies like asthma.
2. **Psychologic effect:** the body and eye contact between mother and infant during breast feeding promote feeling of security and love bonding between the baby and his mother.
3. **Protection against illness:** e.g. diabetes mellitus, hypertension, and cancer.
4. **Intelligence promotion:** breast fed infants achieve higher scores than artificially fed infants.

Breast Feeding

❑ **Advantages of breast feeding:**

A. Benefits to the mother:

1. Breast feeding is a natural contraceptive.
2. Control of post partum hemorrhage by the action of oxytocin.
3. Decrease the risk of breast and ovarian cancer.



Breast Feeding

- **Advantages of breast feeding:**

A. Benefits to the society:

1. Breast feeding decrease for the family and the society the budget needed for the formula milk.
2. Decrease health care costs.
3. Help the efforts of the community for family planning.



Breast Feeding

- **Proper breast feeding practices:**

A. Initiate breast feeding as early as possible and within the first hour after birth.

B. Establish good breast feeding skills:

i. Proper positioning: the mother should either sit or lie comfortably, with her back well supported, leaning slightly forward. The baby should be held close to the mother and facing the breast.



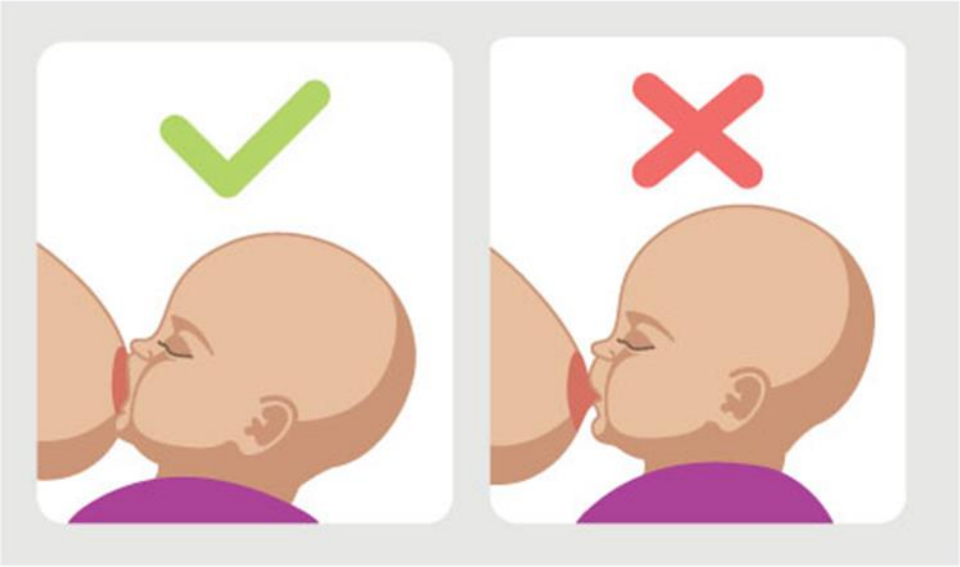


Breast Feeding

❑ **Proper breast feeding practices:**

A. Establish good breast feeding skills:

i. Proper attachment: infant's mouth should open wide just before attaching so that the nipple and as much of the areola as possible are in the mouth.



Breast Feeding

❑ **Proper breast feeding practices:**

A. Establish good breast feeding skills:

iii. Burping (eructation): it is done by making the baby sit on his mother's lap, or resting him against her shoulder and gently but firmly rubbing his back in a circular motion.



Breast Feeding

❑ **Proper breast feeding practices:**

C. Breast feeding exclusively in the first six months.

D. On demand frequent feeding.

E. Night feedings.

F. Feeding from the two breasts.

G. Breast feeding should continue through 24 months and beyond.





Breast Feeding

❑ **Indicators of breast feeding adequacy:**

- The baby sleeps 2-4 hours between feeds.
- The baby exhibits adequate weight gain.
- The baby urinates six or more times per day.
- Bowel movements occur several times per day.
- The mother feels breasts are emptied after feeding.



Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

1) **Engorged breasts**: duo to an excess milk in the breasts when milk production is more than its withdrawal.

- Management:

- Moist packs on the breasts before feeding.
- Cold packs on the breasts after feeding.
- Frequent and effective feedings.
- Frequent emptying of breasts by hand or pump if mother and infant are separated.

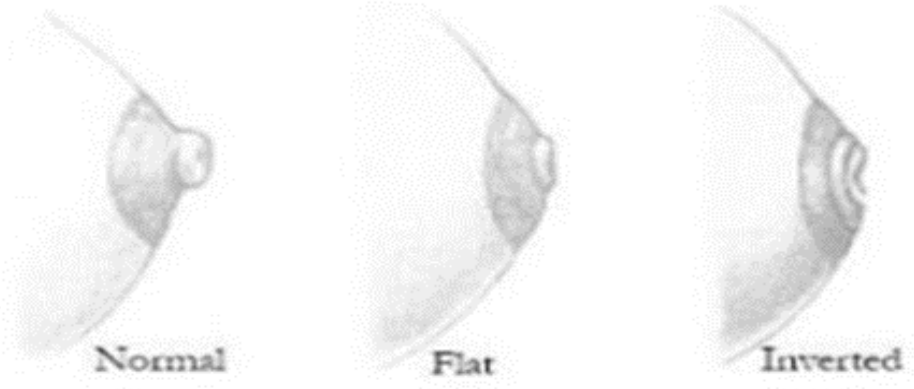
Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

2) Flat or inverted nipples:

❖ Management:

- Daily pulls and stretches the nipples in all directions
- Breast pump before feeding to pull the nipples out.
- Breast feed in a side lying position for greater head control.



Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

3) Sore or painful nipple: caused by feeding in the wrong position.

❖ Management:

- Good nipple care.
- Feeding should be started on the less painful breast.
- Nursing for shorter time, but more often.
- The baby should have both the nipple and areola in his mouth.
- The nipple should be left dry thoroughly before it is covered.

Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

4) Cracked nipple:

❖ Management:

- Use good nipple care techniques and all of the relief measures.
- Consider using a nursing nipple shield.





Breast Feeding

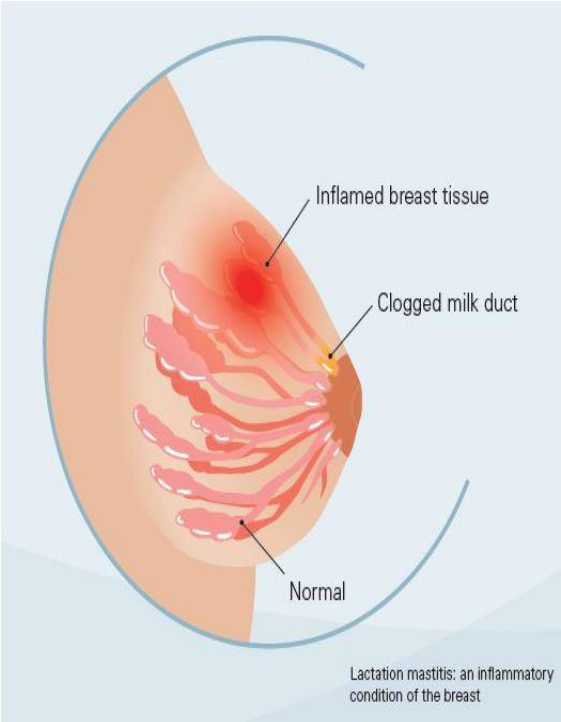
❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

5) Mastitis:

The breast becomes larger or more painful. Flu like symptoms e.g. fever and chills may be present. Untreated mastitis can develop into breast abscess.

❖ Management:

- Feed your baby frequently to empty the milk.
- Warm packs on the affected breast continuously.
- Drink plenty of fluids and eat well balanced diet.



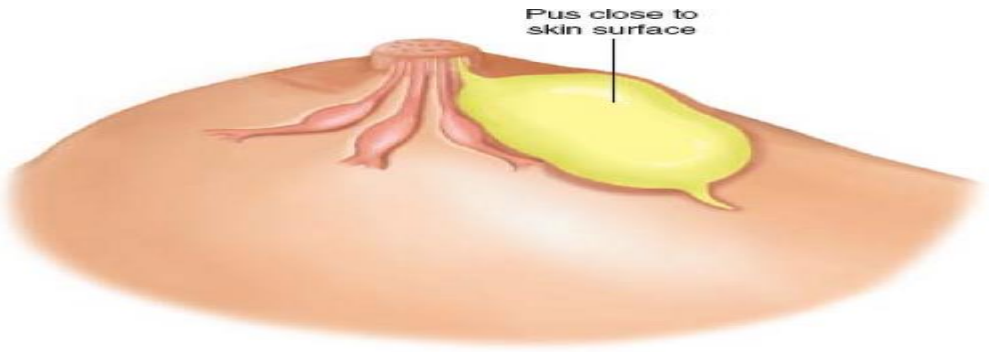
Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

6) Breast abscess:

❖ Management:

- Incision and drainage and antibiotic is given.
- The mother may be advised to discontinue nursing on the affected side. To maintain the milk supply, express milk from the affected side at regular feeding times.



Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

7) Diminished milk supply:

❖ Management:

- Adequate maternal rest.
- Nurse in a relaxed position.
- Reduce outside activities that are strenuous.
- Increase the fluid intake.
- Nurse the baby more often.



Breast Feeding

❑ **Common problems during breast feeding:**

8) Baby's refusal to breast feed:

The cause may be faulty feeding technique or the baby is uncomfortable or has an infection or other illness.

❖ Management:

- The breast should be offered to the baby frequently.
- Stimulate the release of milk by gentle hand expression just before starting feeding.
- Different positions of feeding should be tried.
- Treat any illness in the infant.




Thank You!